

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Mrs Kanthimathi Sivan Pillai

Address: 11 Jeffs Road Cheam SM1 2JE

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer objects to the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: The proposed site is situated within an area already subject to substantial traffic congestion and acute peak-time pressure.

The immediate vicinity includes a primary school with a pupil capacity in excess of 1,000, generating exceptionally high volumes of pedestrian and vehicular movement during morning drop-off and afternoon pick-up periods. These times are characterised by congestion, limited parking availability, reduced visibility at junctions, and increased vulnerability for children and accompanying parents.

In addition, nearby recreational facilities, including tennis courts and an elderly residents' golf facility, contribute to sustained vehicle circulation throughout the day and evening. These uses attract both regular visitors and older residents, many of whom may have reduced mobility, thereby heightening the sensitivity of the area in terms of highway safety and pedestrian protection.

The introduction of a community hall, temple, mosque, church, or any comparable assembly use would inevitably result in concentrated arrival and departure patterns, particularly during evenings, weekends, and religious or community events. Such uses typically generate peak, overlapping traffic flows rather than dispersed movements. This would significantly intensify existing congestion, exacerbate on-street parking stress, increase instances of obstructive or unsafe parking, compromise emergency vehicle access, and materially reduce road safety for schoolchildren, elderly residents, and other pedestrians.

When assessed cumulatively, the existing pressures and the sensitive character of surrounding uses clearly demonstrate that the site is unsuitable for further high-intensity, assembly-based development. The proposal would materially worsen highway safety conditions and adversely affect residential amenity.